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2026 FIFA World Cup

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● Light
○ Dark

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"2026 World Cup" redirects here. For other competitions of that name, see 2026 World Cup (disambiguation).

The **2026 FIFA World Cup** will be the 23rd FIFA World Cup, the quadrennial international men's soccer championship contested by the national teams of the member associations of FIFA. The tournament will take place from June 11 to July 19, 2026.[1] It will be jointly hosted by sixteen cities—eleven in the United States, three in Mexico, and two in Canada. The tournament will be the first FIFA World Cup hosted by three nations, and the first to include 48 teams, an expansion from 32.

The United 2026 bid beat a rival bid by Morocco during a final vote at the 68th FIFA Congress in Moscow. It will be the first men's World Cup since 2002 to be co-hosted by multiple nations. With its past hosting of the 1970 and 1986 tournaments, Mexico will become the first country to host or co-host the men's World Cup three times. The United States previously hosted the men's World Cup in 1994. By contrast, it will be Canada's first time hosting or co-hosting the men's tournament. The event will return to its traditional Northern Hemisphere summer schedule after the 2022 World Cup in Qatar was held in November and December.

As the host nations, Canada, Mexico, and the United States all automatically qualified. Cape Verde, Curaçao, Jordan, and Uzbekistan will all make their World Cup debuts. Argentina is the defending champion, having won its third World Cup title in 2022.

2026 FIFA World Cup

Copa Mundial de la FIFA 2026
Coupe du Monde de la FIFA 2026

We Are 26
Somos 26
Nous Sommes 26

Tournament details

Host countries	Canada Mexico United States
Dates	June 11 – July 19
Teams	48 (from 6 confederations)
Venue	16 (in 16 host cities)

← 2022 2030 →

Part of a series on the
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v·t·e

Format and expansion

The idea of expanding the tournament had been suggested as early as 2013 by then UEFA president Michel Platini,[2][3] and also in 2016 by FIFA president Gianni Infantino.[4] Opponents of the proposal argued that the number of games played was already at an unacceptable level,[5] that the expansion would dilute the quality of the games,[6][7] and that the decision was driven by political rather than sporting concerns, accusing Infantino of using the promise of bringing more countries to the World Cup to win his election.[8]

Starting with this edition, the FIFA World Cup expanded to 48 teams, an increase of 16 teams compared to the previous seven tournaments.[9] The teams will be split into twelve groups of four teams, with the top two teams in each group and the eight best third-placed teams progressing to a new round of 32, as approved by the FIFA Council on March 14, 2023.[10] This is set to be the first expansion and format change since 1998.

The total number of games played will increase from 64 to 104, and the number of games played by teams reaching the final four will increase from seven to eight. The tournament will last 39 days, an increase from 32 days of the 2014 and 2018 tournaments.[11][12] Each team will still play three group matches.[13][14] The final matchday at club level for players named in the final squads is May 24, 2026; clubs have to release their players by May 25, with exceptions granted to players participating in continental club competition finals up until May 30. The 56 days of the combined rest, release, and tournament periods remain identical to the 2010, 2014 and 2018 tournaments.[10]

Previous expansion formats

The expansion to 48 teams had already been approved on January 10, 2017, when it was decided that the tournament would include 16 groups of 3 teams, and 80 matches in total, with the top two teams of each group progressing to a round of 32.[9][15] Under this later-superseded format, the maximum number of games per team would have remained at seven, but each team would have played one fewer group match than before. The tournament would still have been completed within 32 days.[16] This format was chosen over three other proposals, ranging from 40 to 48 teams, from 76 to 88 matches, and from one to four minimum matches per team.[17][18][19]

Critics of this format argued that the use of three-team groups with two teams progressing significantly increased the risk of collusion between teams.[20] This prompted FIFA to suggest that penalty shootouts may be used to prevent draws in the group stage,[21] although even then some risk of collusion would remain, and a possibility would emerge of teams deliberately losing shootouts to eliminate a rival.[20] To address these concerns, FIFA continued considering alternative formats[22] – a process that ended with the 2023 announcement that the format would be 12 groups of 4 teams.

Host selection

Main articles: United 2026 FIFA World Cup bid and Morocco 2026 FIFA World Cup bid

The FIFA Council went back and forth between 2013 and 2017 on limitations within hosting rotation based on the continental confederations. Originally, it was set that bids to be host would not be allowed from countries belonging to confederations that hosted the two preceding tournaments. It was temporarily changed to only prohibit countries belonging to the confederation that hosted the previous World Cup from bidding to host the following tournament,[23] before the rule was changed back to its prior state of two World Cups.

The FIFA Council made an exception to potentially grant eligibility to member associations of the confederation of the second-to-last host of the FIFA World Cup in the event that none of the received bids fulfill the strict technical and financial requirements.[24][25] In March 2017, FIFA president Gianni Infantino confirmed that "Europe (UEFA) and Asia (AFC) are excluded from the bidding following the selection of Russia and Qatar in 2018 and 2022 respectively."[26] Therefore, the 2026 World Cup could be hosted by one of the remaining four confederations: CONCACAF (North America; last hosted in 1994), CAF (Africa; last hosted in 2010), CONMEBOL (South America; last hosted in 2014), or OFC (Oceania, never hosted before), or potentially by UEFA in case no bid from those four met the requirements.

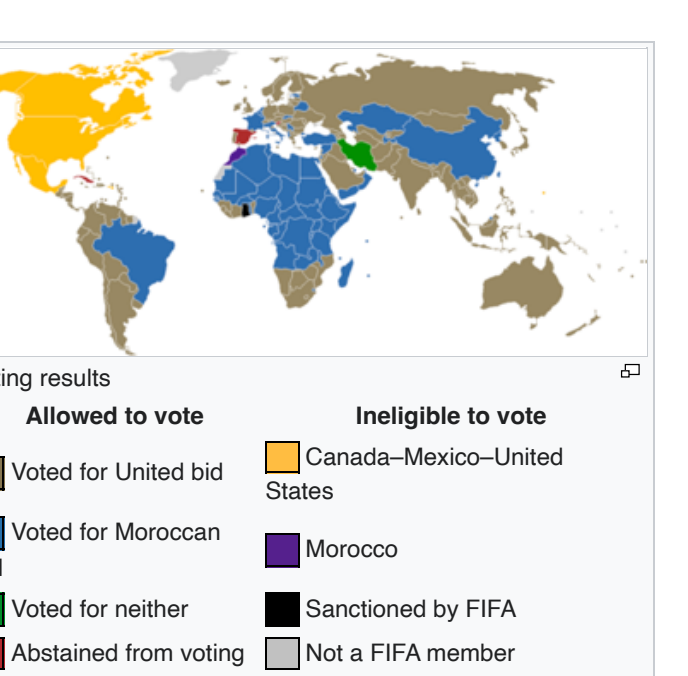
Co-hosting the FIFA World Cup—which had been banned by FIFA after the 2002 World Cup—was approved for the 2026 World Cup, though not limited to a specific number but instead evaluated on a case-by-case basis. Also for 2026, the FIFA general secretariat, after consultation with the Competitions Committee, had the power to exclude bidders who did not meet the minimum technical requirements to host the competition.[24]

Canada, Mexico, and the United States had each publicly considered bidding for the tournament separately, but the United joint bid was announced on April 10, 2017.[27][28] In March 2022, Liga MX president Mikel Arriola claimed Mexico's involvement as cohost could have been at risk if the league and the federation had not responded quickly to the Querétaro–Atlas riot between rival fans that left 26 spectators injured and resulted in 14 arrests. Arriola said FIFA was "shocked" by the incident but Infantino was satisfied with the sanctions handed down against Querétaro.[29]

Voting

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup bids

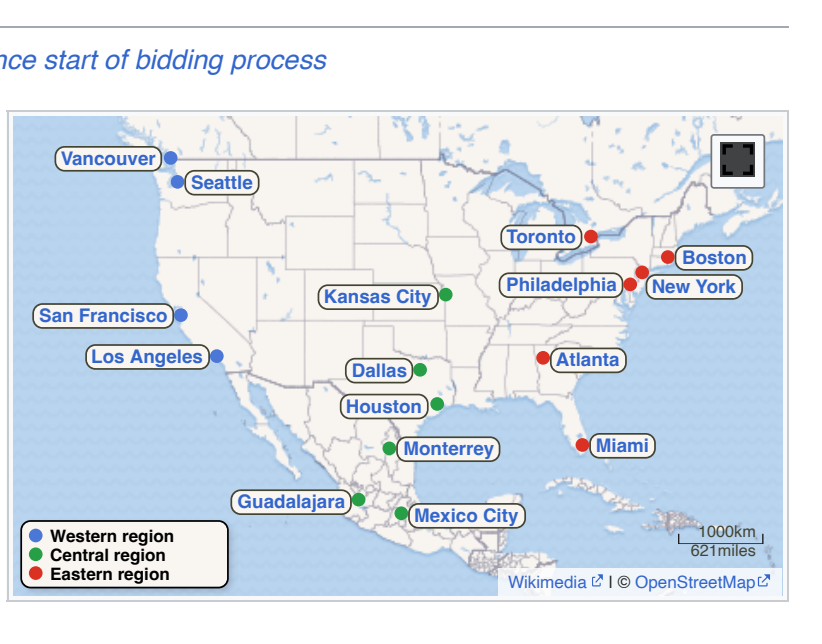
The voting took place on June 13, 2018, during the 68th FIFA Congress in Moscow, and it was opened to all 203 eligible members.[30] The United bid won with 134 valid ballots, while the Morocco bid received 65 valid ballots.[31][28] Iran voted for the option "None of the bids", while Cuba, Slovenia, and Spain abstained from voting. Ghana was suspended by FIFA due to a corruption scandal and was therefore ineligible to vote.[32][33][34][35][36]


Voting results

Nation	Vote
	Round 1
Canada, Mexico, United States	**134**
Morocco	65
None of the bids	1
Abstentions	3
Total votes	**200**
Required for majority	**101**

Venues

See also: United 2026 FIFA World Cup bid § Venues excluded since start of bidding process



During the bidding process, 41 cities with 42 existing, fully functional venues with regular tenants (except Montreal) and two venues under construction (Las Vegas and Los Angeles) submitted to be part of the bid (three venues in three cities in Mexico; six venues in six cities in Canada; 35 venues in 32 cities in the United States).[37] A first-round elimination cut nine venues and nine cities. A second-round elimination cut an additional nine venues in six cities, while three venues in three cities (Chicago, Minneapolis, and Vancouver) dropped out due to FIFA's unwillingness to discuss financial details.[38] After Montreal dropped out in July 2021 due to lack of provincial funding and support to renovate Olympic Stadium,[39] Vancouver rejoined the bid as a candidate city in April 2022,[40] bringing the total number to 24 venues, each in its own city or metropolitan area.

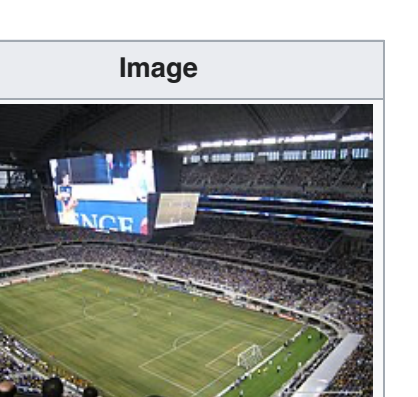
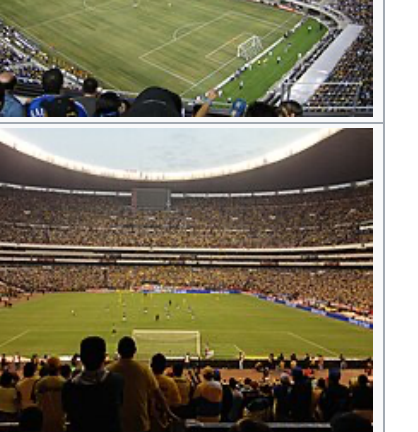
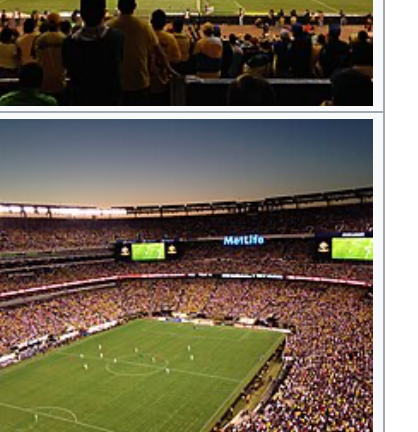
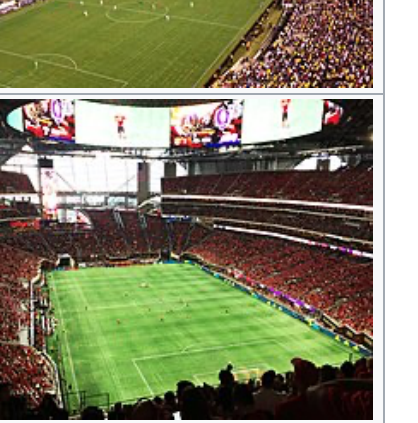
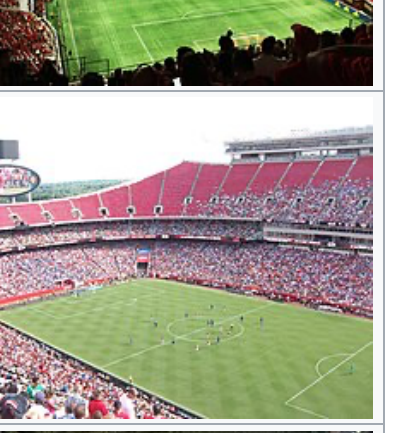
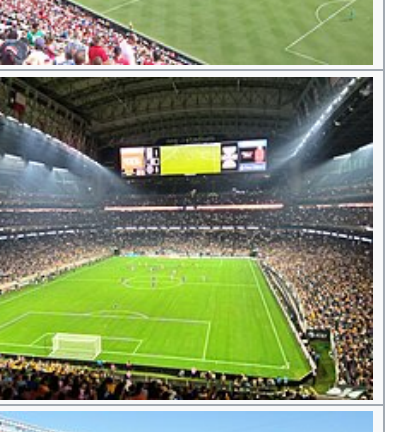
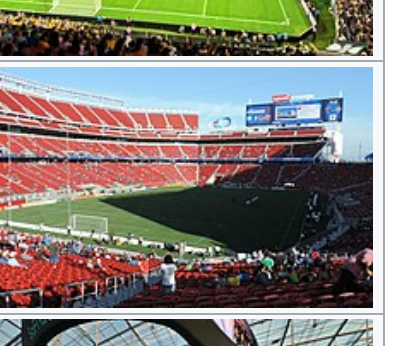
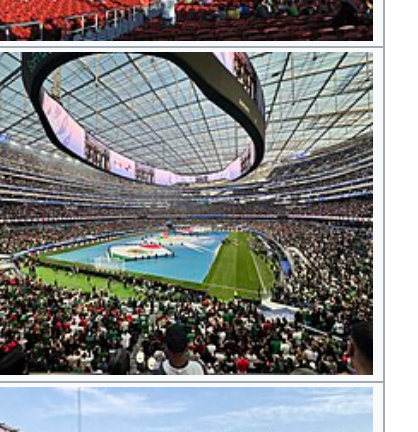
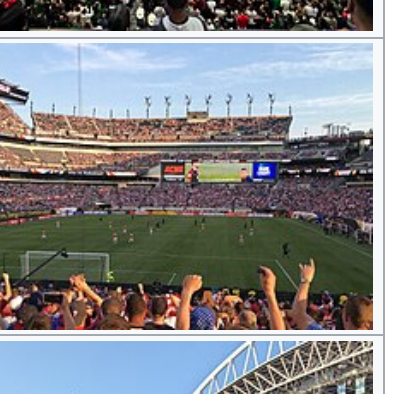
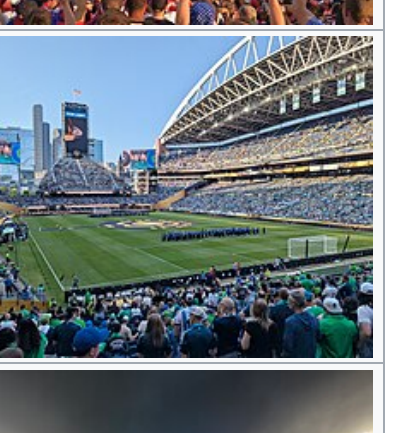
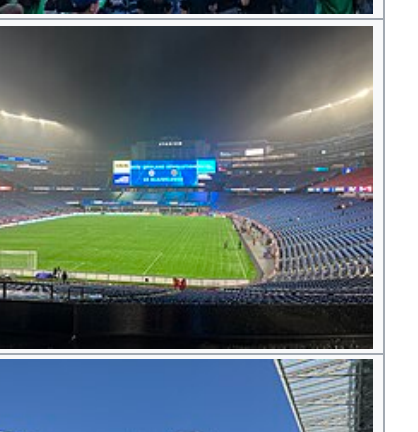
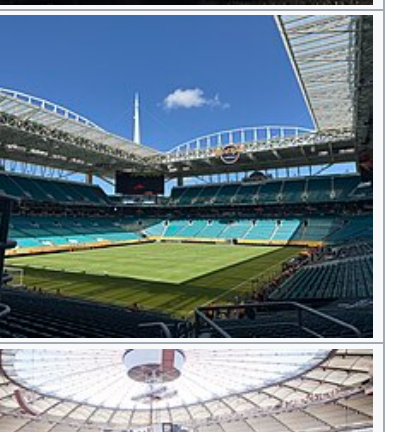
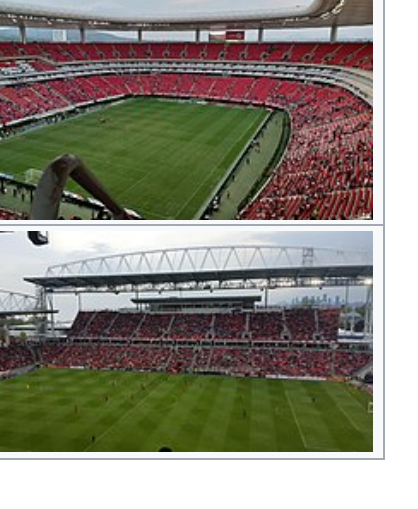
On June 16, 2022, the sixteen host cities (two in Canada, three in Mexico, eleven in the United States) were announced by FIFA: Atlanta, Boston, Dallas, Guadalajara, Houston, Kansas City, Los Angeles, Mexico City, Miami, Monterrey, New York/New Jersey, Philadelphia, San Francisco Bay Area, Seattle, Toronto, and Vancouver.[41] Eight of the sixteen chosen stadiums have permanent artificial turf surfaces that are planned to be replaced with grass under the direction of FIFA and a University of Tennessee–Michigan State University research team. Four venues (Atlanta, Dallas, Houston, and Vancouver) are indoor stadiums that use retractable roof systems, all equipped with climate control while a fifth, Los Angeles, is open-air but has a translucent roof and no climate control.[42] The host of the final match—MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford, New Jersey—was announced by FIFA on February 4, 2024.[43]

Although there are soccer-specific stadiums in Canada and the United States, the largest dedicated soccer-specific stadium in the United States, Geodis Park in Nashville, Tennessee, seats 30,000, which falls short of FIFA's minimum of 40,000 (Toronto's BMO Field is being expanded from 30,000 to 45,500 for this tournament).[44] Stadiums including Mercedes-Benz Stadium in Atlanta, Gillette Stadium in Foxborough, Massachusetts, and Lumen Field in Seattle are used by National Football League (NFL) and Major League Soccer (MLS) teams.[45] Although primarily used for gridiron football, with the American stadiums hosting NFL teams and Canada's hosting the Canadian Football League (CFL), all of the Canadian and American stadiums have been used on numerous occasions for soccer and are also designed to host that sport.[46]

Mexico City is the only capital of the three host nations chosen as a venue site, with Ottawa and Washington, D.C., joining Bonn (West Germany, 1974) and Tokyo (Japan, 2002) as the only capital cities not selected to host World Cup matches. Washington was a host city candidate, but due to the poor state of FedExField, it combined its bid with nearby Baltimore's, which was unsuccessful. Other cities eliminated from the final hosting list were Cincinnati, Denver, Nashville, Orlando, and Edmonton. Ottawa's candidate venue, TD Place Stadium, was eliminated early on due to insufficient capacity.[47] None of the stadiums used in the 1994 FIFA World Cup will be used in this tournament, and Estadio Azteca is the only stadium in this tournament that was used in the 1970 and 1986 FIFA World Cups.[48]

Due to FIFA's rules on stadium sponsorships, the venues will use alternative names for the duration of the tournament, shown below in parentheses.[49][50] The capacity is based on information published by FIFA.[50]

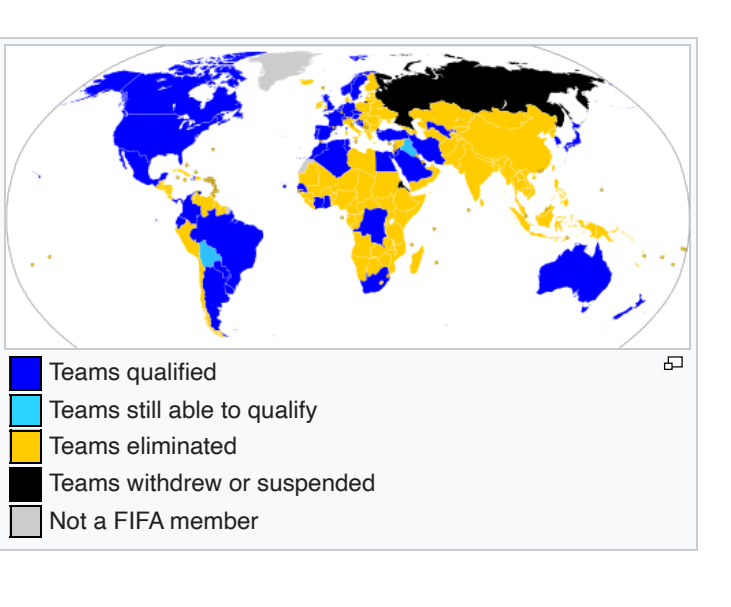
A † denotes a stadium used for previous men's World Cup tournaments.
A ‡ denotes an indoor stadium with a fixed or retractable roof with interior climate control.

City	Stadium	Capacity	Image
Dallas (Arlington, Texas)	AT&T Stadium‡ (Dallas Stadium)	94,000	
Mexico City	Estadio Banorte† (Mexico City Stadium)	83,000	
New York/New Jersey (East Rutherford, New Jersey)	MetLife Stadium (New York / New Jersey Stadium)	82,500	
Atlanta	Mercedes-Benz Stadium‡ (Atlanta Stadium)	75,000	
Kansas City	GEHA Field at Arrowhead Stadium (Kansas City Stadium)	73,000	
Houston	NRG Stadium‡ (Houston Stadium)	72,000	
San Francisco Bay Area (Santa Clara, California)	Levi's Stadium (San Francisco Bay Area Stadium)	71,000	
Los Angeles (Inglewood, California)	SoFi Stadium (Los Angeles Stadium)	70,000	
Philadelphia	Lincoln Financial Field (Philadelphia Stadium)	69,000	
Seattle	Lumen Field (Seattle Stadium)	69,000	
Boston (Foxborough, Massachusetts)	Gillette Stadium (Boston Stadium)	65,000	
Miami (Miami Gardens, Florida)	Hard Rock Stadium (Miami Stadium)	65,000	
Vancouver	BC Place‡ (BC Place Vancouver)	54,000	
Monterrey (Guadalupe)	Estadio BBVA (Estadio Monterrey)	53,500	
Guadalajara (Zapopan)	Estadio Akron (Estadio Guadalajara)	48,000	
Toronto	BMO Field (Toronto Stadium)	45,000	

Teams

Qualification

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup qualification



The United Bid personnel anticipated that all three host countries would be awarded automatic berths.[51] On August 31, 2022, FIFA president Gianni Infantino confirmed that six CONCACAF teams will qualify for the World Cup, with Canada, Mexico, and the United States automatically qualifying as hosts.[52][53] This was confirmed by the FIFA Council on February 14, 2023.[54][55]

Immediately prior to the 67th FIFA Congress, the FIFA Council approved the slot allocation in a meeting in Manama, Bahrain.[56][57] This includes an intercontinental playoff tournament involving six teams to decide the last two FIFA World Cup spots.[58]

The six teams in the playoffs will comprise one team from each confederation excluding UEFA, and one additional team from the confederation of the host countries (CONCACAF). Two of the teams will be seeded based on the World Rankings, and they will play the winners of two knockout games between the four unseeded teams for the two FIFA World Cup berths. The four-game tournament is to be played in one or more of the host countries, and will also be used as a test event for the FIFA World Cup.[56] The ratification of slot allocation also gives the OFC a guaranteed berth in the final tournament for the first time: the 2026 FIFA World Cup will be the first tournament in which all six confederations have at least one guaranteed berth and also the first time since the 2010 edition in which all confederations have a team qualified for the World Cup finals.[56]

Eritrea withdrew from qualification prior to playing any matches, due to concerns that players would seek political asylum if allowed to travel overseas.[59][60][61] Congo, drawn in the same group as Eritrea, was suspended on February 6, 2025, due to government interference in FECOFOOT operations.[62][63] CAF initially cancelled Congo's remaining matches.[64] However, Tanzania and Zambia were later awarded 3–0 victories by forfeit.[65] The suspension was lifted by FIFA on May 14, 2025.[66]

Of the 47 qualified teams, 26 also appeared in the 2022 edition. Highlights include:

- Cape Verde,[67] Curaçao,[A][68] Jordan, and Uzbekistan[B][69] will all make their World Cup debuts.
- DR Congo and Haiti return to the tournament after appearing in their only previous tournament in 1974.[68]
- Austria, Norway,[70] and Scotland return to the tournament after last appearing in 1998.[71]
- South Africa achieved its first successful qualifying campaign since 2002, as it automatically qualified as host in 2010.[72] Turkey also had its first successful qualifying campaign since finishing third in 2002.[citation needed]
- Czech Republic qualified for the first time since 2006.[citation needed]
- Qatar advanced to the tournament through qualification for the first time.[73]

The teams that have qualified to date, sorted by region:

AFC (8)

- Australia
- Iran[C]
- Japan
- Jordan (debut)
- Qatar
- Saudi Arabia
- South Korea[D]
- Uzbekistan (debut)

CAF (10)

- Algeria
- Cape Verde[E] (debut)
- DR Congo[F]
- Egypt
- Ghana
- Ivory Coast[G]
- Morocco
- Senegal
- South Africa
- Tunisia

CONCACAF (6)

- Canada (co-host)
- Curaçao (debut)
- Haiti
- Mexico (co-host)
- Panama
- United States[H] (co-host)

CONMEBOL (6)

- Argentina
- Brazil
- Colombia
- Ecuador
- Paraguay
- Uruguay

OFC (1)

- New Zealand

UEFA (16)

- Austria
- Belgium
- Bosnia and Herzegovina
- Croatia
- Czech Republic[I]
- England
- France
- Germany
- Netherlands
- Norway
- Portugal
- Scotland
- Spain
- Sweden
- Switzerland
- Turkey[J]

Draw

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup seeding

The draw took place on December 5, 2025, at the Kennedy Center in Washington, D.C.[74] The 48 teams were divided into four pots of 12. Pot 1 consisted of the three hosts and the top nine teams from the November 2025 FIFA Men's World Ranking. Pots 2, 3, and 4 consisted of the remaining teams according to the ranking. The four winners of the UEFA playoffs and the two winners of the inter-confederation playoffs were not known at the time of the draw, as these matches are scheduled to take place in March 2026, and thus were automatically allocated to Pot 4. The 12 groups were randomly formed by selecting one team from each of the four pots. FIFA's "general principle, whenever possible", was that no group had more than one team from the same confederation drawn into it.[75][76] This principle was applicable to all confederations except UEFA; each group was required to have either one or two UEFA teams drawn into it.

The three host nations were pre-allocated to three groups for scheduling purposes. Mexico was placed in Group A and will play the opening match of the tournament at Estadio Azteca on June 11. Canada and the United States were placed in Groups B and D, respectively. They will play the third and fourth matches of the tournament, respectively, both on June 12.[1][77]

The confederation restriction applied to all three potential winners of the inter-confederation playoffs. FIFA also announced that, "in the interest of ensuring competitive balance", two separate pathways to the semifinals (sides of the knockout bracket) were established. Based on this, the teams ranked first (Spain) and second (Argentina) in the ranking were randomly drawn into groups in opposite pathways, as were the teams ranked third (France) and fourth (England). Therefore, should these pairs of teams win their groups, they will be unable to meet until the final, while all four will be unable to meet until the semifinals.[78] The draw started with Pot 1 and ended with Pot 4, with each team selected then allocated into the first available group alphabetically. For the purpose of the match schedule, the Pot 1 teams were automatically drawn into position 1 of each group. For the remaining pots, FIFA established a predetermined pattern to define the position of teams based on their pot and the group they were drawn into.

Pots[K]

Pot 1	Pot 2	Pot 3	Pot 4
1. United States *(co-host)* (14)	13. Croatia (10)	25. Norway (29)	37. Jordan (66)
2. Mexico *(co-host)* (15)	14. Morocco (11)	26. Panama (30)	38. Cape Verde (68)
3. Canada *(co-host)* (27)	15. Colombia (13)	27. Egypt (34)	39. Ghana (72)
4. Spain (1)	16. Uruguay (16)	28. Algeria (35)	40. Curaçao (82)
5. Argentina (2)	17. Switzerland (17)	29. Scotland (36)	41. Haiti (84)
6. France (3)	18. Japan (18)	30. Paraguay (39)	42. New Zealand (86)
7. England (4)	19. Senegal (19)	31. Tunisia (40)	43. UEFA Path A winners[L]
8. Brazil (5)	20. Iran (20)	32. Ivory Coast (42)	44. UEFA Path B winners[L]
9. Portugal (6)	21. South Korea (22)	33. Uzbekistan (50)	45. UEFA Path C winners[L]
10. Netherlands (7)	22. Ecuador (23)	34. Qatar (51)	46. UEFA Path D winners[L]
11. Belgium (8)	23. Austria (24)	35. Saudi Arabia (60)	47. IC Path 1 winners[L][M]
12. Germany (9)	24. Australia (26)	36. South Africa (61)	48. IC Path 2 winners[L][N]

Result

Group A

Pos	Team
A1	*Mexico*
A2	South Africa
A3	South Korea
A4	Czech Republic[O]

Group B

Pos	Team
B1	*Canada*
B2	Bosnia and Herzegovina[P]
B3	Qatar
B4	Switzerland

Group C

Pos	Team
C1	Brazil
C2	Morocco
C3	Haiti
C4	Scotland

Group D

Pos	Team
D1	*United States*
D2	Paraguay
D3	Australia
D4	Turkey[Q]

Group E

Pos	Team
E1	Germany
E2	Curaçao
E3	Ivory Coast
E4	Ecuador

Group F

Pos	Team
F1	Netherlands
F2	Japan
F3	Sweden[R]
F4	Tunisia

Group G

Pos	Team
G1	Belgium
G2	Egypt
G3	Iran
G4	New Zealand

Group H

Pos	Team
H1	Spain
H2	Cape Verde
H3	Saudi Arabia
H4	Uruguay

Group I

Pos	Team
I1	France
I2	Senegal
I3	IC Path 2 winners
I4	Norway

Group J

Pos	Team
J1	Argentina
J2	Algeria
J3	Austria
J4	Jordan

Group K

Pos	Team
K1	Portugal
K2	DR Congo[S]
K3	Uzbekistan
K4	Colombia

Group L

Pos	Team
L1	England
L2	Croatia
L3	Ghana
L4	Panama

Team base camps

Base camps will be used by the 48 national squads to stay and train before and during the World Cup tournament.[80][81][82][83]

List of team base camps
[show]

Match schedule

The match schedule, without group assignments, was announced on February 4, 2024.[1][119][120] On June 13, 2024, FIFA released an updated schedule, with specific pairings assigned to venues for the knockout stage.[121] In addition, group stage matches were assigned to specific groups (though pairings for non-host groups were not assigned to specific games until after the final draw). The full schedule was unveiled in a live broadcast on December 6, 2025, the day after the draw.[122]

The opening match was announced to include Mexico, taking place on June 11, 2026, at the Estadio Azteca in Mexico City. This game will include South Africa. The opening match involving Canada will take place on June 12 at BMO Field in Toronto, while the opening game for the United States will take place on the same day at SoFi Stadium in Inglewood. Each host nation is scheduled to play its three matches in the group stage within its own country.

AT&T Stadium in Arlington, Texas, will host the most matches of any venue at the tournament with nine. MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford, New Jersey, will host the final on July 19. The United States will host 78 matches, including from the quarterfinal stage onward, while Canada and Mexico will each host 13. Each tournament venue, except for the Estadio Akron, will host at least one knockout stage fixture.[123] The match schedule will overlap with the 2026 CFL season, resulting in scheduling conflicts and loss of home games for the Toronto Argonauts and BC Lions.[124][125] The match schedule will also affect the schedules of the Kansas City Royals, Philadelphia Phillies, Seattle Mariners, and Texas Rangers of Major League Baseball, whose home stadiums are located near World Cup venues.[126]

Host cities were geographically grouped into three regions:[1]

- Western Region (Vancouver, Seattle, San Francisco, Los Angeles)
- Central Region (Guadalajara, Mexico City, Monterrey, Houston, Dallas, Kansas City)
- Eastern Region (Atlanta, Miami, Toronto, Boston, Philadelphia, New York/New Jersey)

Schedule by round

Round	Matchday	Date
Group stage	Matchday 1	June 11–17, 2026
	Matchday 2	June 18–23, 2026
	Matchday 3	June 24–27, 2026
Knockout stage	Round of 32	June 28 – July 3, 2026
	Round of 16	July 4–7, 2026
	Quarterfinals	July 9–11, 2026
	Semifinals	July 14–15, 2026
	Match for third place	July 18, 2026
	Final	July 19, 2026

Schedule by group

Matchday	Pairings	Groups	Date
Matchday 1	1 vs 2 3 vs 4	A	June 11, 2026
		B & D	June 12, 2026
		B, C & D	June 13, 2026
		E & F	June 14, 2026
		G & H	June 15, 2026
		I & J	June 16, 2026
		K & L	June 17, 2026
Matchday 2	1 vs 3 4 vs 2	A & B	June 18, 2026
		C & D	June 19, 2026
		E & F	June 20, 2026
		G & H	June 21, 2026
		I & J	June 22, 2026
		K & L	June 23, 2026
Matchday 3	4 vs 1 2 vs 3	A, B & C	June 24, 2026
		D, E & F	June 25, 2026
		G, H & I	June 26, 2026
		J, K & L	June 27, 2026

Group stage

Tie-breaking criteria for group stage ranking [show]

Prior to the final draw, stadiums were assigned to specific groups.[1] Following the final draw, pairings were allocated to specific matches, and the kickoff times were confirmed.[120][128]

All times are local.

Group A

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group A

Pos	Team [v·t·e]	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Mexico **(H)**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	South Africa	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	South Korea	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Czech Republic	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 11, 2026. Source: FIFA
(H) Hosts

June 11, 2026 1:00 p.m. UTC−6	**Mexico**	**Match 1** Report	**South Africa**	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
June 11, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−6	**South Korea**	**Match 2** Report	**Czech Republic**	Estadio Akron, Zapopan
June 18, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−4	**Czech Republic**	**Match 25** Report	**South Africa**	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
June 18, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−6	**Mexico**	**Match 28** Report	**South Korea**	Estadio Akron, Zapopan
June 24, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−6	**Czech Republic**	**Match 53** Report	**Mexico**	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
June 24, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−6	**South Africa**	**Match 54** Report	**South Korea**	Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe

Group B

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group B

Pos	Team [v·t·e]	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Canada **(H)**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Bosnia and Herzegovina	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Qatar	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Switzerland	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 12, 2026. Source: FIFA
(H) Hosts

June 12, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−4	**Canada**	**Match 3** Report	**Bosnia and Herzegovina**	BMO Field, Toronto
June 13, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	**Qatar**	**Match 8** Report	**Switzerland**	Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara
June 18, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	**Switzerland**	**Match 26** Report	**Bosnia and Herzegovina**	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
June 18, 2026	**Canada**	**Match 27**	**Qatar**	BC Place, Vancouver

June 18, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−7	Canada	Match 27 Report	Qatar	BC Place, Vancouver
June 24, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	Switzerland	Match 51 Report	Canada	BC Place, Vancouver
June 24, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	Bosnia and Herzegovina	Match 52 Report	Qatar	Lumen Field, Seattle

Group C

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group C

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Brazil	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Morocco	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Haiti	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Scotland	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 13, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 13, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	Brazil	Match 7 Report	Morocco	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
June 13, 2026 9:00 p.m. UTC−4	Haiti	Match 5 Report	Scotland	Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
June 19, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	Scotland	Match 30 Report	Morocco	Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
June 19, 2026 9:00 p.m. UTC−4	Brazil	Match 29 Report	Haiti	Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia
June 24, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	Scotland	Match 49 Report	Brazil	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
June 24, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	Morocco	Match 50 Report	Haiti	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Group D

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group D

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	United States (H)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Paraguay	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Australia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Turkey	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 12, 2026. Source: FIFA
(H) Hosts

June 12, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−7	United States	Match 4 Report	Paraguay	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
June 13, 2026 9:00 p.m. UTC−7	Australia	Match 6 Report	Turkey	BC Place, Vancouver
June 19, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	United States	Match 32 Report	Australia	Lumen Field, Seattle
June 19, 2026 9:00 p.m. UTC−7	Turkey	Match 31 Report	Paraguay	Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara
June 25, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−7	Turkey	Match 59 Report	United States	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
June 25, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−7	Paraguay	Match 60 Report	Australia	Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

Group E

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group E

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Germany	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Curaçao	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Ivory Coast	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Ecuador	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 14, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 14, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Germany	Match 10 Report	Curaçao	NRG Stadium, Houston
June 14, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−4	Ivory Coast	Match 9 Report	Ecuador	Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia
June 20, 2026 4:00 p.m. UTC−4	Germany	Match 33 Report	Ivory Coast	BMO Field, Toronto
June 20, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−5	Ecuador	Match 34 Report	Curaçao	Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City
June 25, 2026 4:00 p.m. UTC−4	Curaçao	Match 55 Report	Ivory Coast	Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia
June 25, 2026 4:00 p.m. UTC−4	Ecuador	Match 56 Report	Germany	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford

Group F

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group F

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Netherlands	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Japan	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Sweden	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Tunisia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 14, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 14, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−5	Netherlands	Match 11 Report	Japan	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
June 14, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−6	Sweden	Match 12 Report	Tunisia	Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe
June 20, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Netherlands	Match 35 Report	Sweden	NRG Stadium, Houston
June 20, 2026 10:00 p.m. UTC−6	Tunisia	Match 36 Report	Japan	Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe
June 25, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−5	Japan	Match 57 Report	Sweden	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
June 25, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−5	Tunisia	Match 58 Report	Netherlands	Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City

Group G

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group G

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Belgium	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Egypt	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Iran	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	New Zealand	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 15, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 15, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	Belgium	Match 16 Report	Egypt	Lumen Field, Seattle
June 15, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−7	Iran	Match 15 Report	New Zealand	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
June 21, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	Belgium	Match 39 Report	Iran	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
June 21, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−7	New Zealand	Match 40 Report	Egypt	BC Place, Vancouver
June 26, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−7	Egypt	Match 63 Report	Iran	Lumen Field, Seattle
June 26, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−7	New Zealand	Match 64 Report	Belgium	BC Place, Vancouver

Group H

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group H

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Spain	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Cape Verde	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Saudi Arabia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Uruguay	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 15, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 15, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−4	Spain	Match 14 Report	Cape Verde	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
June 15, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	Saudi Arabia	Match 13 Report	Uruguay	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
June 21, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−4	Spain	Match 38 Report	Saudi Arabia	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
June 21, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	Uruguay	Match 37 Report	Cape Verde	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
June 26, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−5	Cape Verde	Match 65 Report	Saudi Arabia	NRG Stadium, Houston
June 26, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−6	Uruguay	Match 66 Report	Spain	Estadio Akron, Zapopan

Group I

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group I

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	France	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Senegal	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	IC Path 2 winner[a]	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Norway	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 16, 2026. Source: FIFA
Notes:

a. ^ The winner of inter-confederation playoff Pathway 2 will be Iraq or Bolivia.

June 16, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−4	France	Match 17 Report	Senegal	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
June 16, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	IC Path 2 winner	Match 18 Report	Norway	Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
June 22, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−4	France	Match 42 Report	IC Path 2 winner	Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia
June 22, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−4	Norway	Match 41 Report	Senegal	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
June 26, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−4	Norway	Match 61 Report	France	Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
June 26, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−4	Senegal	Match 62 Report	IC Path 2 winner	BMO Field, Toronto

Group J

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group J

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Argentina	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Algeria	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Austria	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Jordan	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 16, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 16, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−5	Argentina	Match 19 Report	Algeria	Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City
June 16, 2026 9:00 p.m. UTC−7	Austria	Match 20 Report	Jordan	Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara
June 22, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Argentina	Match 43 Report	Austria	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
June 22, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−7	Jordan	Match 44 Report	Algeria	Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara
June 27, 2026 9:00 p.m. UTC−5	Algeria	Match 69 Report	Austria	Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City
June 27, 2026 9:00 p.m. UTC−5	Jordan	Match 70 Report	Argentina	AT&T Stadium, Arlington

Group K

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group K

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Portugal	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	DR Congo	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Uzbekistan	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Colombia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 17, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 17, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Portugal	Match 23 Report	DR Congo	NRG Stadium, Houston
June 17, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−6	Uzbekistan	Match 24 Report	Colombia	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
June 23, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Portugal	Match 47 Report	Uzbekistan	NRG Stadium, Houston
June 23, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−6	Colombia	Match 48 Report	DR Congo	Estadio Akron, Zapopan
June 27, 2026 7:30 p.m. UTC−4	Colombia	Match 71 Report	Portugal	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
June 27, 2026 7:30 p.m. UTC−4	DR Congo	Match 72 Report	Uzbekistan	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Group L

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup Group L

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	England	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	Croatia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	Ghana	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	Panama	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 17, 2026. Source: FIFA

June 17, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−5	England	Match 22 Report	Croatia	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
June 17, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−4	Ghana	Match 21 Report	Panama	BMO Field, Toronto
June 23, 2026 4:00 p.m. UTC−4	England	Match 45 Report	Ghana	Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
June 23, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−4	Panama	Match 46 Report	Croatia	BMO Field, Toronto
June 27, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−4	Panama	Match 67 Report	England	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
June 27, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−4	Croatia	Match 68 Report	Ghana	Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia

Ranking of third-placed teams

Pos	Grp	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	A	Third place Group A	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	Advance to knockout stage
2	B	Third place Group B	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
3	C	Third place Group C	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
4	D	Third place Group D	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
5	E	Third place Group E	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
6	F	Third place Group F	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
7	G	Third place Group G	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
8	H	Third place Group H	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
9	I	Third place Group I	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
10	J	Third place Group J	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
11	K	Third place Group K	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	
12	L	Third place Group L	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**0**	

First match(es) will be played: June 11, 2026. Source: FIFA
Rules for classification: 1) Points; 2) Goal difference; 3) Goals scored; 4) Team conduct score; 5) Latest FIFA ranking; 6) Previous FIFA ranking(s).

The specific match-ups involving the third-placed teams depend on which eight third-placed teams qualify for the round of 32. The 495 possible combinations were published in Annex C of the tournament regulations.[127]

Combinations of matches in the round of 32 [hide]

No.	Third-placed teams advance from groups												1A vs	1B vs	1D vs	1E vs	1G vs	1I vs	1K vs	1L vs
1					E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	3E	3J	3I	3F	3H	3G	3L	3K
2				D		F	G	H	I	J	K	L	3H	3G	3I	3D	3J	3F	3L	3K
3				D	E		G	H	I	J	K	L	3E	3J	3I	3D	3H	3G	3L	3K
4				D	E	F		H	I	J	K	L	3E	3J	3I	3D	3H	3F	3L	3K
5				D	E	F	G		I	J	K	L	3E	3G	3I	3D	3J	3F	3L	3K
6				D	E	F	G	H		J	K	L	3E	3G	3J	3D	3H	3F	3L	3K
7				D	E	F	G	H	I		K	L	3E	3G	3I	3D	3H	3F	3L	3K
8				D	E	F	G	H	I	J		L	3E	3G	3J	3D	3H	3F	3L	3I
9				D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K		3E	3G	3J	3D	3H	3F	3I	3K
10			C			F	G	H	I	J	K	L	3H	3G	3I	3C	3J	3F	3L	3K
11			C		E		G	H	I	J	K	L	3E	3J	3I	3C	3H	3G	3L	3K
12			C		E	F		H	I	J	K	L	3E	3J	3I	3C	3H	3F	3L	3K
13			C		E	F	G		I	J	K	L	3E	3G	3I	3C	3J	3F	3L	3K
14			C		E	F	G	H		J	K	L	3E	3G	3J	3C	3H	3F	3L	3K
15			C		E	F	G	H	I		K	L	3E	3G	3I	3C	3H	3F	3L	3K
16			C		E	F	G	H	I	J		L	3E	3G	3J	3C	3H	3F	3L	3I
17			C		E	F	G	H	I	J	K		3E	3G	3J	3C	3H	3F	3I	3K
18			C	D			G	H	I	J	K	L	3H	3G	3I	3C	3J	3D	3L	3K
19			C	D		F		H	I	J	K	L	3C	3J	3I	3D	3H	3F	3L	3K
20			C	D		F	G		I	J	K	L	3C	3G	3I	3D	3J	3F	3L	3K

Knockout stage

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup knockout stage

Bracket

Round of 32 | Round of 16 | Quarterfinals | Semifinals | Final

June 29 – Foxborough
Winner Group E
3rd Group A/B/C/D/F
June 30 – East Rutherford
Winner Group I
3rd Group C/D/F/G/H
June 28 – Inglewood
Runner-up Group A
Runner-up Group B
June 29 – Guadalupe
Winner Group F
Runner-up Group C
July 2 – Toronto
Runner-up Group K
Runner-up Group L
July 2 – Inglewood
Winner Group H
Runner-up Group J
July 1 – Santa Clara
Winner Group D
3rd Group B/E/F/I/J
July 1 – Seattle
Winner Group G
3rd Group A/E/H/I/J
June 29 – Houston
Winner Group C
Runner-up Group F
June 30 – Arlington
Runner-up Group E
Runner-up Group I
June 30 – Mexico City
Winner Group A
3rd Group C/E/F/H/I
July 1 – Atlanta
Winner Group L
3rd Group E/H/I/J/K
July 3 – Miami Gardens
Winner Group J
Runner-up Group H
July 3 – Arlington
Runner-up Group D
Runner-up Group G
July 2 – Vancouver
Winner Group B
3rd Group E/F/G/I/J
July 3 – Kansas City
Winner Group K
3rd Group D/E/I/J/L

July 4 – Philadelphia
Winner Match 74
Winner Match 77
July 4 – Houston
Winner Match 73
Winner Match 75
July 6 – Arlington
Winner Match 83
Winner Match 84
July 6 – Seattle
Winner Match 81
Winner Match 82
July 5 – East Rutherford
Winner Match 76
Winner Match 78
July 5 – Mexico City
Winner Match 79
Winner Match 80
July 7 – Atlanta
Winner Match 86
Winner Match 88
July 7 – Vancouver
Winner Match 85
Winner Match 87

July 9 – Foxborough
Winner Match 89
Winner Match 90
July 10 – Inglewood
Winner Match 93
Winner Match 94
July 11 – Miami Gardens
Winner Match 91
Winner Match 92
July 11 – Kansas City
Winner Match 95
Winner Match 96

July 14 – Arlington
Winner Match 97
Winner Match 98
July 15 – Atlanta
Winner Match 99
Winner Match 100

July 19 – East Rutherford
Winner Match 101
Winner Match 102

Match for third place
July 18 – Miami Gardens
Loser Match 101
Loser Match 102

Round of 32

June 28, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	Runner-up Group A	Match 73 Report	Runner-up Group B	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
June 29, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Winner Group C	Match 76 Report	Runner-up Group F	NRG Stadium, Houston
June 29, 2026 4:30 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Group E	Match 74 Report	3rd Group A/B/C/D/F	Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
June 29, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−6	Winner Group F	Match 75 Report	Runner-up Group C	Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe
June 30, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Runner-up Group E	Match 78 Report	Runner-up Group I	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
June 30, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Group I	Match 77 Report	3rd Group C/D/F/G/H	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
June 30, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−6	Winner Group A	Match 79 Report	3rd Group C/E/F/H/I	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
July 1, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Group L	Match 80 Report	3rd Group E/H/I/J/K	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
July 1, 2026 1:00 p.m. UTC−7	Winner Group G	Match 82 Report	3rd Group A/E/H/I/J	Lumen Field, Seattle
July 1, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−7	Winner Group D	Match 81 Report	3rd Group B/E/F/I/J	Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara
July 2, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	Winner Group H	Match 84 Report	Runner-up Group J	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
July 2, 2026 7:00 p.m. UTC−4	Runner-up Group K	Match 83 Report	Runner-up Group L	BMO Field, Toronto
July 2, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−7	Winner Group B	Match 85 Report	3rd Group E/F/G/I/J	BC Place, Vancouver
July 3, 2026 1:00 p.m. UTC−5	Runner-up Group D	Match 88 Report	Runner-up Group G	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
July 3, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Group J	Match 86 Report	Runner-up Group H	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
July 3, 2026 8:30 p.m. UTC−5	Winner Group K	Match 87 Report	3rd Group D/E/I/J/L	Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City

Round of 16

July 4, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−5	Winner Match 73	Match 90 Report	Winner Match 75	NRG Stadium, Houston
July 4, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Match 74	Match 89 Report	Winner Match 77	Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia
July 5, 2026 4:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Match 76	Match 91 Report	Winner Match 78	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
July 5, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC−6	Winner Match 79	Match 92 Report	Winner Match 80	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
July 6, 2026 2:00 p.m. UTC−5	Winner Match 83	Match 93 Report	Winner Match 84	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
July 6, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−7	Winner Match 81	Match 94 Report	Winner Match 82	Lumen Field, Seattle
July 7, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Match 86	Match 95 Report	Winner Match 88	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
July 7, 2026 1:00 p.m. UTC−7	Winner Match 85	Match 96 Report	Winner Match 87	BC Place, Vancouver

Quarterfinals

July 9, 2026 4:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Match 89	Match 97 Report	Winner Match 90	Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
July 10, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC−7	Winner Match 93	Match 98 Report	Winner Match 94	SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
July 11, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Match 91	Match 99 Report	Winner Match 92	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
July 11, 2026 8:00 p.m. UTC−5	Winner Match 95	Match 100 Report	Winner Match 96	Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City

Semifinals

July 14, 2026 2:00 p.m. UTC−5	Winner Match 97	Match 101 Report	Winner Match 98	AT&T Stadium, Arlington
July 15, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Match 99	Match 102 Report	Winner Match 100	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Match for third place

July 18, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC−4	Loser Match 101	Match 103 Report	Loser Match 102	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

Final

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup final

July 19, 2026 3:00 p.m. UTC−4	Winner Match 101	Match 104 Report	Winner Match 102	MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford

Statistics

Discipline

A player or team official is automatically suspended for the next match for the following offenses:[127]

- Receiving a red card (red card suspensions may be extended for serious offenses)
- Receiving two yellow cards in two matches;[T] yellow cards expire after the completion of the quarterfinals (yellow card suspensions are not carried forward to any other future international matches)

Only pending red card suspensions from qualification will be carried forward to the final tournament.[127]

During qualification, Cristiano Ronaldo was sent off for violent conduct in Portugal's penultimate match, with such an offense typically resulting in a ban of at least two matches. Ronaldo was handed a three-match ban, though the final two matches of the ban were suspended for a one-year probationary period, making him eligible to appear in Portugal's opening World Cup match.[129]

The following suspensions will be served during the tournament:

Player	Offense(s)	Suspension(s)
Nicolás Otamendi	🟥 in CONMEBOL round robin vs Ecuador (September 9, 2025)[130]	Group J vs Algeria (matchday 1; June 16)
Moisés Caicedo	🟨🟥 in CONMEBOL round robin vs Argentina (September 9, 2025)[130]	Group E vs Ivory Coast (matchday 1; June 14)
Tarek Salman	🟥 in AFC fourth round vs United Arab Emirates (October 14, 2025)[131]	Group B vs Switzerland (matchday 1; June 13) Group B vs Canada (matchday 2; June 18)

Marketing

Branding

Countdown clock on Paseo de la Reforma, Mexico City

The official emblem and brand identity was unveiled on May 17, 2023, at the Griffith Observatory in Los Angeles, California; its basic form consists of a stacked "26" with an image of the FIFA World Cup Trophy in front of it (marking the first time that the trophy has been depicted in a World Cup emblem as a photo, as opposed to a stylized representation), but it is designed to be adaptable to different backdrops.[132][133] The next day, FIFA unveiled variants of the emblem for each of the host cities, which feature color variants and designs that reflect local landscapes or culture (with the Los Angeles emblem featuring a stylized sun and wave, the Monterrey emblem featuring imagery of the Cerro de la Silla mountain, and Toronto featuring the city skyline and the CN Tower).[134][135]

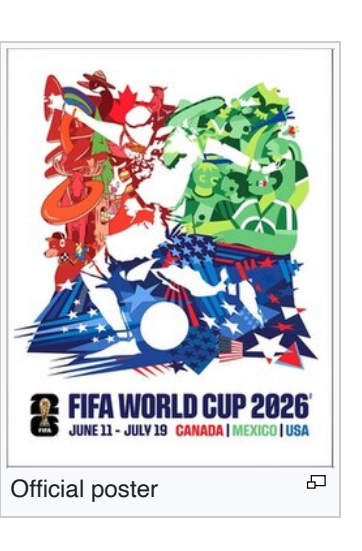
Reaction to the logo from the initial unveiling was largely negative, with many feeling that the design was either unfinished or uncreative compared to the emblems of past FIFA World Cup tournaments. By contrast, United States national team player Jesús Ferreira described the emblem as "beautiful".[136][133][137]

Posters

In April 2025, FIFA unveiled a set of 16 posters representing each of the 2026 World Cup host cities. Each poster has been a vibrant celebration of local culture, landmarks, and soccer spirit, capturing the unique identity of every host city in this tournament.[138][139]

List of posters and artists

[show]


FIFA WORLD CUP 2026
JUNE 11 - JULY 19 CANADA | MEXICO | USA
Official poster

On March 3, 2026, the official poster was unveiled. For the first time, three artists combined their skills and artistic styles to create the official poster: Carson Ting (Canada), Minerva GM (Mexico), and Hank Willis Thomas (United States).[138]

Broadcasting rights

Main article: 2026 FIFA World Cup broadcasting rights

On February 12, 2015, FIFA renewed the United States and Canadian broadcasting rights contracts for Fox (U.S. English), NBCUniversal (U.S. Spanish), and Bell Media (Canada) to cover the 2026 World Cup, without accepting any other bids. A report in *The New York Times* asserted that this extension was intended as compensation for the rescheduling of the 2022 World Cup to November–December rather than its traditional June–July scheduling, as it created considerable conflicts with major professional sports leagues that are normally in their offseasons during the World Cup.[140][141][142]

Fútbol de Primera has the Spanish radio broadcasting rights in the United States and Puerto Rico.[143]

The International Broadcast Center (IBC) will be located at the Kay Bailey Hutchison Convention Center in Dallas.[144][145][146]

On January 8, 2026, FIFA signed a deal to make TikTok a "preferred platform" for World Cup video content. As part of the agreement, broadcasters may stream parts of games at a dedicated hub on the TikTok app.[147] FIFA then made a similar "preferred platform" deal with YouTube on March 17, allowing broadcasters to stream select games in full on their respective YouTube channels, as well as stream the first 10 minutes of every game on the platform as "an appetizer encouraging young fans then to watch on traditional channels".[148] It was later confirmed that YouTube had extended this deal with FIFA and CazéTV to show all tournament games for free in Brazil.[149][150]

Sponsorships

FIFA partners	FIFA World Cup sponsors	FIFA World Cup supporters
• Adidas[151] • Aramco[152] • Coca-Cola[153] • Hyundai–Kia[154] • Lenovo[155] • Qatar Airways[156] • Visa[157]	• AB InBev (Budweiser)[158] • American Airlines[159] • Bank of America[160] • Frito-Lay (Lay's)[161] • Hisense[162] • McDonald's[163] • Mengniu Dairy[164] • Unilever (Dove Men+Care)[165] • Verizon[166]	• DoorDash[167] • Marriott Bonvoy[168] • Rock-it Cargo[169] • Valvoline[170]

Regional supporters

North American supporters	South American supporters	European supporters

- Airbnb[171] - Diageo[172] - Globant[173] - Home Depot[174][175]	- Diageo[172]	- Globant[173]

Domestic sponsors

Atlanta	Boston	Dallas	Guadalajara
- Cox Enterprises[175][176] - Georgia-Pacific[175][176] - Home Depot[175][176] - NAPA Auto Parts[177] - Southern Company[175][176]	- Meet Boston[178] - Sanofi[179] - State Street[179]	- Arca Continental[180] - Choctaw Casinos & Resorts[181] - North Texas Sports Foundation[182] - UT Southwestern[182]	- TBD
Houston	**Kansas City**	**Los Angeles**	**Monterrey**
- Aramco[183] - Arca Continental[183] - Houston Methodist Hospital[183] - NRG Energy[184] - Quanta Services[183] - Rice University[185] - Visit Sugar Land[186]	- Black & Veatch[187] - Hallmark[188] - J. E. Dunn Construction[188] - Populous[189] - Purina[189] - University of Kansas Health System[188]	- Amgen[190] - Archer Aviation[190] - Discover Los Angeles[191] - Los Angeles Metro[192]	- TBD
Mexico City	**Miami**[193]	**New York/New Jersey**	**Philadelphia**[194]
- TBD	- Royal Caribbean[195]	- Bristol Myers Squibb[196] - Hackensack Meridian Health[197] - Onyx Equities[198] - Paul, Weiss, Rifkind, Wharton & Garrison[199] - Public Service Enterprise Group[200] - Sports Illustrated[201]	- Cencora - Comcast - Independence Blue Cross - PECO Energy Company - Penn Medicine - Philadelphia Eagles - VisitPA - William Penn Foundation
San Francisco Bay Area[202]	**Seattle**	**Toronto**	**Vancouver**
- Boston Consulting Group - Electronic Arts - Genentech - Kaiser Permanente	- Puyallup Tribe of Indians[203]	- Humber Polytechnic[204] - Ontario Power Generation[205][206] - Toronto FC[206]	- TBD

FIFA fan festivals

FIFA will stage fan festivals in cities across the host nations, featuring matches on giant screens and live entertainment.[207] Among the confirmed fan fest locations are Liberty State Park in Jersey City,[207] Fairmount Park in Philadelphia,[208] Fort York and The Bentway in Toronto,[209] and East Downtown Houston.[210]

Tickets

Ticket prices for the 2026 FIFA World Cup initially ranged from $60 for group stage matches to $6,730 for the final—largely increased from the USD equivalent of $69 to $1,607 in the 2022 FIFA World Cup. However, in September 2025, FIFA confirmed it would use dynamic pricing for tickets for the first time, following the practice used in the 2025 FIFA Club World Cup.[211] Hospitality seats were made available in April 2025 via FIFA's ticket partner for the event.[citation needed]

An initial draw period for non-hospitality seats occurred between September 10–19, 2025, limited to Visa cardholders. A second phase ran from October 27–31, and a third phase started after the final draw of teams on December 5. Sales are capped at four tickets per person per match, and no person is able to purchase more than 40 tickets for the overall tournament. FIFA is also expected to launch an official resale platform.[211]

Merchandise

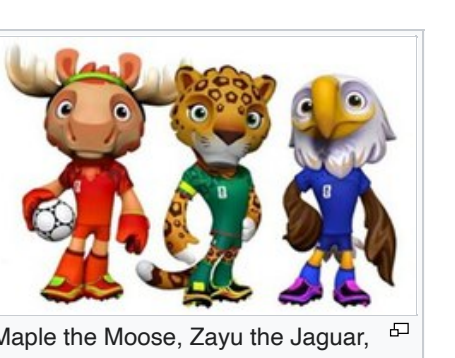
See also: FIFA World Cup video games

On October 2, 2025, FIFA announced *FIFA Heroes* as the official video game of the 2026 FIFA World Cup, scheduled for release in 2026 on Android, iOS, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, and Xbox platforms.[212]

Symbols

Mascots

See also: List of FIFA World Cup official mascots



Maple the Moose, Zayu the Jaguar, and Clutch the Bald Eagle

The official mascots of the tournament were revealed on September 25, 2025, and are Maple, Zayu, and Clutch. Maple is a moose, Zayu is a jaguar, and Clutch is a bald eagle, representing Canada, Mexico, and the United States respectively.[213] They were designed to reflect the cultural heritage of their respective countries.[214]

Match ball

Main article: Adidas Trionda

See also: List of FIFA World Cup official match balls

Adidas Trionda

On May 2, 2025, reports surfaced that the match ball would be called Adidas Trionda. The design features red, green, and blue (the three colors representing Canada, Mexico, and the United States, respectively, and also featured on the host countries' flags), as well as a white wave connecting each of the colors, hence the name using the Spanish words for three (tri) and wave (onda).[215] The design also features the national symbols of the three host countries (a maple leaf for Canada, a golden eagle for Mexico, and a five-pointed star for the United States) as well as gold embellishments to represent the World Cup Trophy.[216]

Music

See also: FIFA World Cup 2026 Official Album and List of FIFA World Cup songs and anthems

On May 17, 2023, the official theme song of the tournament was released, an instrumental track simply titled "FIFA World Cup 26 Theme Song".[217] The first song of the album is "Lighter", performed by Jelly Roll and Carín León, released on March 20, 2026.[218][219] In March 2025, sixteen remixes of theme were released which featured artists from each host city giving their own local spin to the song.[220] The remixers for each city were:

- Atlanta – Dallas Austin
- Boston – Ben Zakharenko, Dayvin, Berklee College of Music
- Dallas – Tre Nagella
- Guadalajara – Bautista
- Houston – Bombón
- Kansas City – Tech N9ne
- Los Angeles – DJ Flict
- Mexico City – Mexican Institute of Sound
- Miami – Mr. NaisGai
- Monterrey – Toy Selectah
- New York/New Jersey – Take a Daytrip
- Philadelphia – DJ Jazzy Jeff
- San Francisco Bay Area – Dan the Automator
- Seattle – Sango
- Toronto – Hill Kourkoutis
- Vancouver – Grayson Repp

Awards

FIFA Peace Prize

Donald Trump receives a certificate as the inaugural FIFA Peace Prize winner in December 2025 from Gianni Infantino for an "unwavering commitment to advancing peace and unity".

The FIFA Peace Prize is an international award presented by FIFA. Established in 2025, its stated aim is to honor individuals whose actions FIFA characterizes as exceptional contributions to peace and unity, reflecting its campaign slogan "Football Unites the World".[221][222] According to FIFA, the purpose of the prize is to "reward individuals who have taken exceptional and extraordinary actions for peace and by doing so have united people across the world".[221]

The FIFA Peace Prize was awarded on December 5, 2025, to United States president Donald Trump during the draw for the 2026 FIFA World Cup, held at the Kennedy Center in Washington, D.C.[223][224][225] FIFA stated that the award recognized his "involvement in ceasefire efforts and diplomatic engagements in several conflicts".[221][226][227]

The creation of the prize and the choice of Trump as its first recipient generated widespread scrutiny and controversy. Human rights groups, analysts and football stakeholders questioned the transparency of the selection process, the suitability of the inaugural laureate, and the implications both for FIFA's claims of political neutrality and its human rights commitments.[228][229][230][231]

Selection process

FIFA stated that the Peace Prize would be awarded on the recommendation of an independent committee. However, as of the first award, the organization had not disclosed detailed nomination procedures or evaluation criteria.[224][222] FIFA had also not made clear the manner by which the recipient was selected or the exact form the prize would take.[232]

According to *The New York Times*, the prize was not discussed at the FIFA Council or with FIFA vice presidents, none of whom had input into the selection criteria, prior to its creation in October 2025.[233] The process behind the award was not made public: there were no nominations announced and no formal selection criteria given.[233][234] Human rights groups, including Human Rights Watch, criticized the lack of transparency, reporting that queries about nominees, judges, and criteria remained unanswered.[235][229][236]

Investigations by *The Guardian* and other outlets identified Zaw Zaw, a Myanmar businessman and long-serving president of the Myanmar Football Federation, as chair of the selection committee.[237][238] Critics highlighted his ties to Myanmar's former military junta and to human rights abuses against the Rohingya people, raising concerns about the credibility of a peace award under his oversight.[237][238][235]

Prize money

In December 2025, FIFA announced the prizes for all participating nations. This edition's total prize pool will be $655 million, $215 million greater than the prize pool of the previous tournament. Each qualified team will also receive an additional $1.5 million before the competition to cover preparation costs, thus guaranteed a minimum $10.5 million total in prize money.[239][240]

Place	Teams	Amount (in millions)	
		Per team	Total
Champions	1	$50	$50
Runners-up	1	$33	$33
Third place	1	$29	$29
Fourth place	1	$27	$27
5th–8th place (quarter-finals)	4	$19	$76
9th–16th place (round of 16)	8	$15	$120
17th–32nd place (round of 32)	16	$11	$176
33rd–48th place (group stage)	16	$9	$144
Total	**48**	**$655**	

Concerns

Climate concerns

In January 2025, Queen's University Belfast warned about potential heat risks for most of the host cities and urged FIFA to schedule match kickoffs later into the afternoon or evening, stating that the wet-bulb globe temperature in certain host cities was higher than that of Qatar in the winter.[241] During the 2025 FIFA Club World Cup, which was also hosted in the United States, several matches reported high temperatures ranging from 90 to 102 °F (32 to 39 °C) and weather delays.[242][243] In December 2025, FIFA announced that all matches at the 2026 World Cup would include a mandatory three-minute hydration break in each half to allow players to rest in hot conditions.[244] The three-minute period would also be available for commercials at the discretion of tournament broadcasters.[245]

Concerns have also been raised by climate activists about the environmental impact of both the expansion to 48 teams as well as traveling between host cities, most of which will require extensive air travel and increase carbon emissions, a counter to one of FIFA's goals on sustainability.[246] A report by Scientists for Global Responsibility in July 2025 calculated that the amount of greenhouse gas emissions for the tournament would make it one of the most polluting events in the world as it would be almost double the average for the last four tournaments (2022 reportedly had 5.25 million metric tons [5.79 million short tons]), roughly the same amount as 6.5 million cars driven for a year.[247]

Immigration policy concerns under the Trump administration

During the bidding process, President Donald Trump's executive orders regarding immigration from certain Muslim-majority countries in 2017 implemented during his first term were touted as a potential risk. Infantino stated, "any team, including the supporters and officials of that team, who qualify for a World Cup need to have access to the country, otherwise there is no World Cup."[26] In response, the Trump administration sent letters to FIFA that read, in part, that Trump was "confident" that "all eligible athletes, officials and fans from all countries around the world would be able to enter the United States without discrimination."[248]

Concerns around the staging of the tournament were also raised during the first meeting of the FIFA World Cup Task Force due to the immigration policy of the second Donald Trump administration. In response, Vice President JD Vance said, "Of course, everybody is welcome to come and see this incredible event, but when the time is up, they'll have to go home. Otherwise, they'll have to talk to Secretary Noem."[249]

On June 11, 2025, the Sports & Rights Alliance, Human Rights Watch, and Amnesty International called on FIFA to ensure that human rights in the United States were upheld during the tournament, especially in light of the use of force during the anti-ICE protests in Los Angeles where journalists and protesters were attacked by local police.[250][251][252] Following the killings of civilians Renée Good and Alex Pretti by federal agents during immigration enforcement operations in the Minneapolis–Saint Paul area in January 2026, fan group Football Supporters Europe stated that it was "extremely concerned by the ongoing militarisation of police forces in the US."[253]

2025 travel ban and exemptions

In June 2025, the second Trump administration reinstated a travel ban affecting citizens from multiple countries, citing national security concerns.[254] The ban, which was later expanded in December, prohibits the issuance of new immigrant and non-immigrant visas for citizens of 39 affected countries, including those whose teams have qualified for the World Cup—Haiti, Iran, Ivory Coast, and Senegal. The proclamation includes an exemption for any athlete or member of an athletic team, including coaches, persons performing a necessary support role, and immediate relatives, traveling for the World Cup, Olympics, or other major sporting events as determined by the Secretary of State.[255][256]

This exemption ensured that national teams' players, coaches, and staff of those designated countries would be permitted to enter the United States for the competition, but the U.S. State Department confirmed that ordinary citizens of the four countries were not covered by this exemption, making them ineligible for visa issuance to attend the matches. While fans were permitted to submit visa applications with the promise of priority if they provided proof of tickets, the department noted that issuance would be unlikely, barring rare "national interest" waivers. However, this restriction can be circumvented if a fan is a valid visa holder, a permanent resident, or a dual national who applies using a passport not subject to the ban. In such cases, applicants may still be eligible to enter or apply for entry, provided they satisfy all other immigration and security requirements.[257][258][259]

Iran's participation

On November 27, 2025, the Football Federation Islamic Republic of Iran (FFIRI) said it would boycott the December 5 World Cup draw after its president, Mehdi Taj, was denied a visa to enter the United States. Four other delegation members, including head coach Amir Ghalenoei, were approved. An FFIRI spokesperson told state media the United States' decision was "unrelated to sport" and said the federation quickly raised the issue with FIFA President Gianni Infantino.[260] However, on December 3, the FFIRI reversed its decision and announced that it would send representatives to the draw, with head coach Ghalenoei serving as the technical representative of the national football team.[261]

Protests and massacres in Iran

See also: 2025–2026 Iranian protests and 2026 Iran massacres

In January 2026, multiple Iranian soccer players and athletes were killed during the 2026 Iran massacres amid protests, including former Tractor Sazi F.C. midfielder Mojtaba Tarshiz, prompting former Iran national team captain Masoud Shojaei to criticize FIFA for its silence over the killing of Iranian athletes during protests, while then-captain Mehdi Taremi expressed solidarity with the Iranian people.[262][263][264][265] Ali Karimi, a former player for the Iran national team, along with a coalition of prominent Iranians, wrote an open letter to FIFA and all its member associations, calling on Infantino to speak up on the protest deaths.[266] Following the massacres, activists and former Iranian wrestling coach Sardar Pashaei called on FIFA and the International Olympic Committee to ban the Iranian teams from the 2026 FIFA World Cup and the 2026 Winter Olympics.[267]

Iran war

See also: 2026 Iran war

Further complications regarding Iran's participation occurred as a result of the 2026 Iran–United States crisis in February 2026, which resulted in the United States and Israel launching missiles at Iran. In retaliation, Iran launched missiles at Israel and Persian Gulf Arab states, as well as additional spillover missile strikes in Jordan. FIFA stated that it was monitoring the situation and was focused on getting all countries to participate, despite reports saying Iran may not participate.[268][269][270]

According to *The Guardian*, if Iran were to withdraw, intercontinental playoff participant Iraq or the United Arab Emirates, the last Asian Football Confederation team to be eliminated from the qualifiers, could be likely beneficiaries to replace it in Group G.[271][272] FIFA has warned that Iran could face fines and a ban from future competitions should it withdraw from the tournament.[273] However, on March 10, Iran hinted that it may do so due to the risk of defections from players, similar to the women's team during the 2026 AFC Women's Asian Cup in Australia.[274]

Following a meeting with U.S. President Trump on March 10, Infantino said that Trump had reiterated that the Iranian team "is, of course, welcome to compete in the tournament in the United States".[275] In a post on Truth Social, Trump later added that, while the team is welcome, it would "[not be] appropriate that they be there, for their own life and safety".[276] In response, Iran asked for FIFA to remove the United States as tournament hosts, referring to Trump's statement that the Iranian team's safety could not be guaranteed.[277][278]

On March 11, Iran's Minister of Sport and Youth, Ahmad Donyamali, reportedly ruled out participation in the World Cup in an interview with Deutsche Presse-Agentur, citing the assassination of Ali Khamenei, and later told Iranian state television that "under no circumstances can we participate in the World Cup", though the team's withdrawal has not been confirmed by FIFA.[279][280]

On March 17, it was reported that FFIRI was negotiating with FIFA to move Iran's scheduled matches from the United States to Mexico, again citing Trump's statement that the Iranian team's safety could not be guaranteed.[281] However, FIFA denied Iran's request to move its matches and said that the schedule will go ahead as planned.[282]

That same day, the Asian Football Confederation stated that it had not received any formal notification from Iran regarding an intention to withdraw from the tournament. Speaking to reporters in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, General Secretary Windsor John said that the final decision rests with FFIRI, adding that "the federation has informed us that they are going to the World Cup." He also expressed hope that Iran would resolve its internal issues and participate, noting that the team was among the first Asian teams to secure qualification, having done so in March 2025.[281]

On March 27, ahead of a scheduled AFC Champions League Elite match, state media reported that Iran's Ministry of Sport and Youth had banned its sports teams from traveling to countries it considers "hostile", but it did not explicitly mention the World Cup.[283]

The Group G host cities, which include Los Angeles and Seattle, as well as Iran's base camp city Tucson, Arizona, reportedly fear increased security risks.[278]

Impact on Iraq

The war also significantly impacted Iraq's logistical preparations for the interconfederation playoffs, needing to win just one match to qualify for the World Cup. Following the closure of Iraqi airspace and the suspension of international flights, the Mexican Secretariat of Foreign Affairs intervened to grant entry visas for the national team through diplomatic channels in Saudi Arabia and Qatar, since Mexico does not have an embassy in Iraq.[284] However, despite the issuance of visas, over 60% of the domestic-based squad remained stranded in Baghdad, and a scheduled training camp in Houston before the playoffs was canceled.[285][286] Head coach Graham Arnold was forced to manage team operations remotely from the United Arab Emirates, as the delegation was unable to secure safe passage out of the conflict zone during the initial weeks of the war.[287]

The Iraq Football Association (IFA) formally petitioned FIFA to postpone the playoff match, citing the impossibility of safe transit for the players and staff.[285] FIFA denied the request, citing the rigidity of the FIFA International Match Calendar, and instead proposed an alternative overland route through Turkey to Istanbul.[286] This proposal was rejected by IFA and Arnold due to security concerns regarding repeated Iranian strikes in the Kurdistan region.[287] Amidst these travel complications, the Mexican government maintained its commitment to the team's participation, working directly with the Iraqi Embassy in Mexico to finalize all documentation. On March 16, it was confirmed that FIFA would provide a chartered private jet to transport the Iraqi team to Mexico.[288] The original plan was for the team to fly on March 20 from the Arar Domestic Airport in Saudi Arabia, near the Iraqi border, and arrive in Monterrey the next day, 10 days before the match.[289] However, further airspace closures in the area forced the group of players and staff based in Iraq to travel overland to Jordan where they departed on a charter flight from Queen Alia International Airport in Amman on March 21. After a technical layover in Lisbon, they arrived in Monterrey minutes after midnight.[290][291]

Pride Match (Egypt vs. Iran)

See also: Egypt vs Iran at the 2026 FIFA World Cup

A "Pride Match" was planned in advance to take place in Seattle, organized by the local committee to tie into the local celebration and without endorsement by FIFA. After the draw and release of the schedule, it was determined that this match would feature Egypt and Iran, two countries where homosexuality is punishable by law.[292] Seattle's Pride Match Advisory Committee spokesperson said "The Pride Match has been scheduled to celebrate and elevate Pride events in Seattle and across the country and it was planned well in advance".[293] Iranian Football Federation President Mehdi Taj said both countries had "objections" and that the branding was an "irrational move that supports a certain group." Iran was planning to appeal the decision.[294] The Egyptian Football Association also sent a formal letter to FIFA Secretary General Mattias Grafström rejecting "in absolute terms" LGBTQ connections to the game.[295]

Human rights and security concerns in Mexico

Labor rights

In March 2025, the trade union Building and Wood Workers' International (BWI) accused FIFA of blocking a planned labor inspection at Mexico City's Estadio Azteca, which is undergoing renovations in preparation for the 2026 FIFA World Cup. According to BWI, FIFA's intervention prevented inspectors from evaluating working conditions at the site, raising concerns about potential labor rights violations similar to alleged instances of slave labor at the 2022 World Cup in Qatar.[296]

Unrest in Jalisco

Following the capture and death of Jalisco New Generation Cartel (CJNG) leader Nemesio "El Mencho" Oseguera Cervantes in Tapalpa on February 22, 2026, retaliatory violence was launched by CJNG members across the state of Jalisco and various other Mexican states which involved shootouts, explosions, and blocking roads using burnt vehicles as well as setting fire to various businesses, raising concerns about security during games played in Guadalajara, Jalisco's largest city. Despite this, FIFA officials have no intentions to move any games and the Mexican government has reassured visitors that security would be guaranteed for visitors.[297][298] In March 2026, Mexico announced that 100,000 troops would be deployed for security during the tournament.[299]

Impact of final game halftime show

On September 28, 2024, FIFA announced that Global Citizen, an international advocacy organization, would co-produce a halftime show for the final game at MetLife Stadium, the first halftime show in the history of the World Cup.[300] The show is intended to copy the format of the Super Bowl halftime show, featuring a well-known musical performer to increase the tournament's commercial appeal in the market.

The show has generated debate in the global soccer community. Supporters argue that the event modernizes the World Cup and provides a platform for global cultural exchange and revenue growth. However, critics, players, media, unions, and traditionalist fan groups have criticized what they view as the "Americanization" of soccer. Primary objections focus on the potential extension of the traditional 15-minute halftime interval, which opponents argued could disrupt player recovery, interfere with technical coaching adjustments, and break the natural flow of the game.[301][302]

Decentralized host committees in the United States

Unlike previous World Cups where there was a centralized organizing committee, each of the 11 U.S. host cities have set up their own individual host committees, with independent deals with FIFA. As a result, most of the financial and legal responsibilities have shifted from a national level to a local one, including the majority of those for infrastructure improvements, public safety and security, and transportation.[303][304]

In February 2026, the Select Board of Foxborough refused to grant the entertainment license to hold games at Gillette Stadium, stating that they still needed $7.8 million upfront in security funding, which is too heavy of a burden for a community with a population of about 18,000 to pay now and wait to be reimbursed later.[303][305] While the federal government had earmarked a total of $625 million for security in the 11 U.S. host cities, it remained unclear how much Foxborough's share would be and when it would receive it.[306] In addition, while the local Boston host committee is responsible for most of the public safety costs, they were still waiting on federal grant funding.[304] The town board had set a deadline of March 17 for the funding issue to be resolved, which was accomplished when Robert Kraft agreed five days before the deadline that his company would pay the bill.[305][307]

Various cities have also had issues regarding the planning of the FIFA Fan Festival, which has resulted in plans for large central fan festivals, typically seen at the tournament, either being cancelled and replaced with smaller community focused festivals or scaled down due to high costs in New York/New Jersey, Miami, and Seattle.[308][309][310]

Notes

A. ^ Curaçao is the smallest country by area and the least populous to qualify for the World Cup. Excluding teams from the United Kingdom, Curaçao is also the first team representing a non-sovereign nation to qualify for the World Cup since the Dutch East Indies (currently Indonesia) in 1938.

B. ^ Until 1991, Uzbekistan was part of the Soviet Union, which competed at seven World Cup tournaments. Following the dissolution of the Soviet Union, Uzbekistan will become the third former Soviet republic to compete as an independent nation after Russia (1994, 2002, 2014 and 2018) and Ukraine (2006). FIFA considers Russia to be the successor team of the Soviet Union.

C. ^ Referred to as IR Iran by FIFA

D. ^ Referred to as Korea Republic by FIFA

E. ^ Referred to as Cabo Verde by FIFA

F. ^ Referred to as Congo DR by FIFA

G. ^ Referred to as Côte d'Ivoire by FIFA

H. ^ Referred to as USA by FIFA

I. ^ Referred to as Czechia by FIFA

J. ^ Referred to as Türkiye by FIFA

K. ^ The number in parentheses indicates the FIFA ranking of teams as of November 19, 2025.[79]

L. ^ a b c d e f The winners of the UEFA play-offs and inter-confederation play-offs were not known at the time of the draw

M. ^ The placeholder for the inter-confederation playoff Pathway 1 winner adhered to the confederation restrictions of a CAF, CONCACAF, or OFC team.

N. ^ The placeholder for the inter-confederation playoff Pathway 2 winner adhered to the confederation restrictions of an AFC, CONCACAF, or CONMEBOL team.

O. ^ UEFA Path D winners

P. ^ UEFA Path A winners

Q. ^ UEFA Path C winners

R. ^ UEFA Path B winners

S. ^ IC Path 1 winners

T. ^ As yellow cards are not carried forward to penalty shootouts, players may be shown two yellow cards in the same match without being sent off. However, this would result in a suspension for accumulating two yellow cards during the tournament.

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